

Korean Parts of Speech

How the vocabulary banks are grouped

The standard English parts of speech, adjusted where Korean genuinely divides things differently. A ● marks a group that exists because English has no clean equivalent. Every vocabulary bank in the workbook — Bab 1-20 and the four TOPIK references — sorts its words into these 14 groups, and each word carries a usage note and a worked example sentence.

Group	Korean	Examples	Words	What it is, and why it is its own group
Nouns	명사	사람, 날씨, 환경	496	Names of things, people, and places. Korean nouns have no articles and no plural ending; particles do the grammatical work.
Pronouns	대명사	저, 나, 누구	20	Stand-ins for nouns. Politeness matters here: 저 is humble, 나 is casual.
Action verbs	동사	가다, 먹다, 참여하다	111	Words for actions. The dictionary form ends in -다 and is never used as-is in a sentence.
Descriptive verbs (adjectives) ●	형용사	좋다, 춥다, 중요하다	67	Korean adjectives are a kind of verb: they conjugate (좋다 → 좋아요) and end a sentence on their own, with no copula.
Adverbs	부사	아주, 빨리, 열심히	38	Modify verbs, adjectives, or whole sentences, and normally sit right before what they modify.
Determiners (before a noun) ●	관형사	무슨, 몇, 어느	11	Sit directly in front of a noun and never take a particle or an ending: 무슨 색, 이 책.
Numbers	수사	하나, 삼, 스물	31	Korean runs two number systems — native Korean and Sino-Korean — and the counter decides which one you use.
Counters (measure words) ●	단위 명사	그루, 벌, 켄레	14	Bound units that follow a number when counting: 사람 세 명, 책 두 권. English has no obligatory equivalent.
Dependent nouns ●	의존 명사	수, 줄, 씨	16	Nouns that cannot stand alone and always need a modifier in front: 것, 수, 때.
Particles ●	조사	쯤	1	Attached to the end of a noun to mark its role — subject, object, topic, place, time.
Conjunctions	접속사	그리고, 그래서, 그런데	5	Join clauses or sentences: 그리고, 그런데, 하지만.
Interjections	감탄사	네, 아니요, 아	5	Standalone reaction words. They never conjugate and never take particles.
Set expressions	관용 표현	안녕하세요, 감사합니다, ~에 관심이 있다	25	Fixed phrases learned whole rather than built from parts, including patterns with a particle slot.
Collocations ●	연어	춤을 추다, 경험을 쌓다, 책임을 지다	20	Word pairings that are fixed in Korean: 춤을 추다, 경험을 쌓다. The noun decides which verb goes with it, so learn the pair together.

The Korean-specific groups

Descriptive verbs are the big one: Korean adjectives conjugate (좋다 → 좋아요) and end a sentence on their own, with no copula — calling them adjectives hides why 좋아요 carries a verb ending. **Determiners** (관형사) sit directly before a noun and never take a particle or an ending. **Counters** are obligatory when counting and have no English equivalent. **Dependent nouns** cannot stand alone and always need a modifier in front. **Particles** attach to a noun to mark its role. **Collocations** are word pairings fixed in Korean, where the noun decides the verb.

Korean grammar treats counters as a subclass of dependent nouns, so counting words that also behave as bound nouns — 명, 권, 마리, 잔, 살 — are listed under **dependent nouns** rather than **counters**. Both groups are counting vocabulary; only the label differs.

Generated from `shared-vocab/word-notes.js`. 860 distinct words across the 24 vocabulary banks; 859 usage notes.